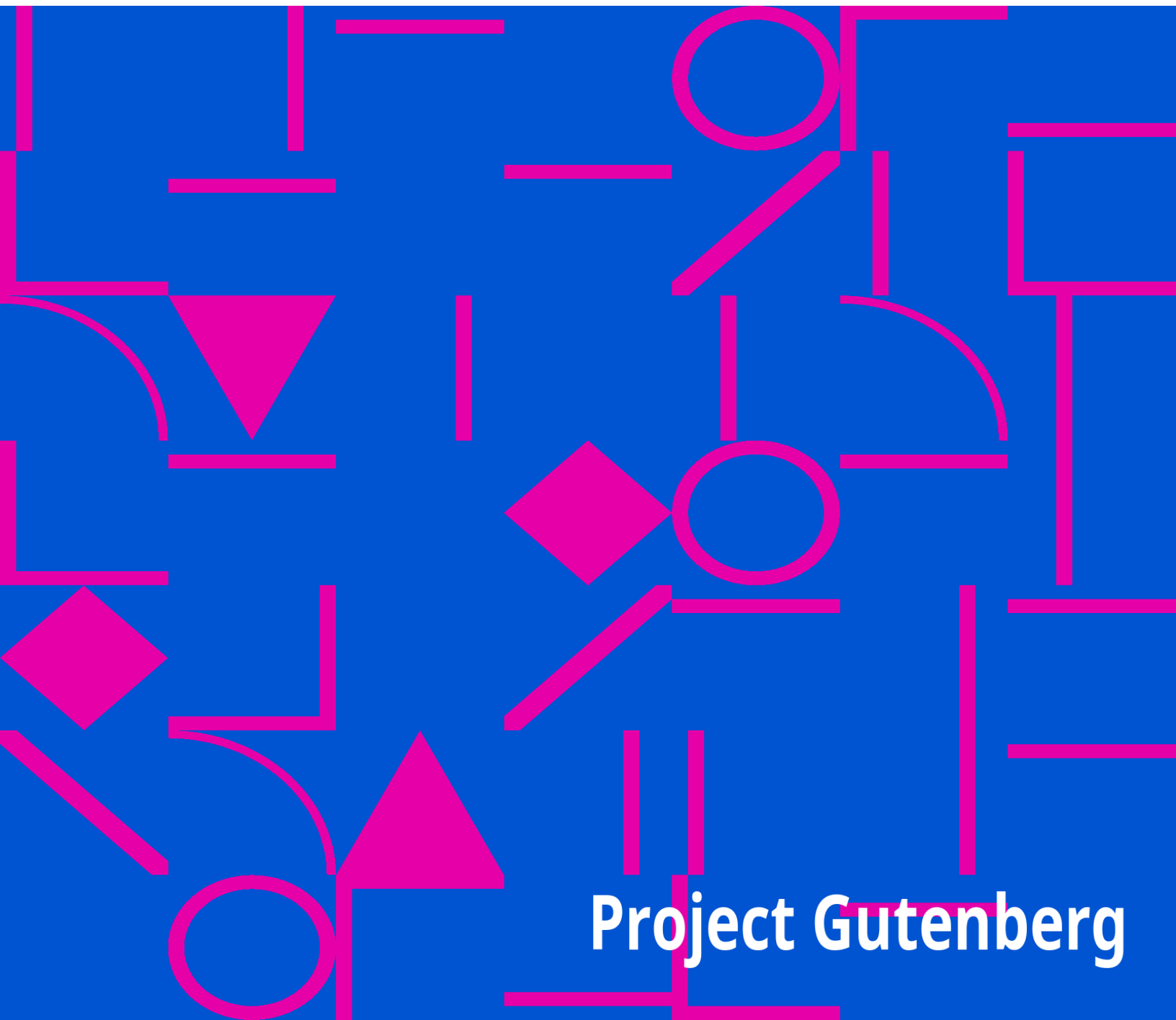


The World English Bible (WEB): Nehemiah

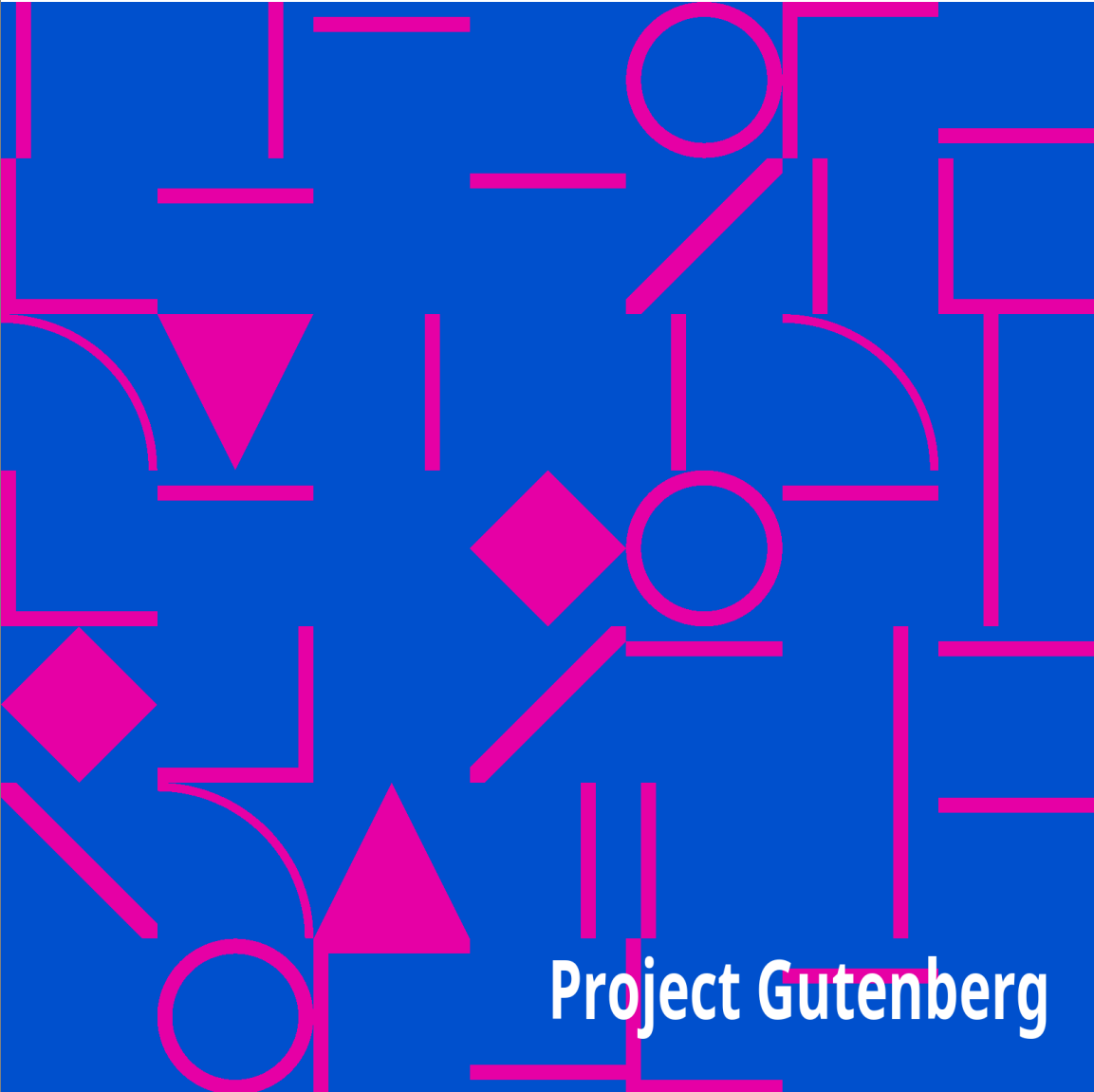
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The World English Bible (WEB): Nehemiah

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Title: The World English Bible (WEB): Nehemiah

Author: Anonymous

Release date: June 1, 2005 [eBook #8243]

Most recently updated: December 26, 2020

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/8243

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE WORLD
ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB): NEHEMIAH ***

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Book 16 Nehemiah 001:001 The words of Nehemiah the son of Hacaliah. Now it happened in the month Chislev, in the twentieth year, as I was in Shushan the palace, 001:002 that Hanani, one of my brothers, came, he and certain men out of Judah; and I asked them concerning the Jews who had escaped, who were left of the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem. 001:003 They said to

me, The remnant who are left of the captivity there in the province are in great affliction and reproach: the wall of Jerusalem also is broken down, and the gates of it are burned with fire. 001:004 It happened, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days; and I fasted and prayed before the God of heaven, 001:005 and said, I beg you, Yahweh, the God of heaven, the great and awesome God, who keeps covenant and loving kindness with those who love him and keep his commandments: 001:006 Let your ear now be attentive, and your eyes open, that you may listen to

the prayer of your servant, which I pray before you at this time, day and night, for the children of Israel your servants while I confess the sins of the children of Israel, which we have sinned against you. Yes, I and my father's house have sinned: 001:007 we have dealt very corruptly against you, and have not kept the commandments, nor the statutes, nor the ordinances, which you commanded your servant Moses. 001:008 Remember, I beg you, the word that you commanded your servant Moses, saying, If you trespass, I will scatter you abroad among the peoples: 001:009 but if you return to me, and keep my

**commandments and do them,
though your outcasts were in the
uttermost part of the heavens, yet
will I gather them from there, and
will bring them to the place that I
have chosen, to cause my name to
dwell there. 001:010 Now these are
your servants and your people,
whom you have redeemed by your
great power, and by your strong
hand. 001:011 Lord, I beg you, let
now your ear be attentive to the
prayer of your servant, and to the
prayer of your servants, who
delight to fear your name; and
please prosper your servant this
day, and grant him mercy in the
sight of this man. Now I was cup**

bearer to the king. 002:001 It happened in the month Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king, when wine was before him, that I took up the wine, and gave it to the king. Now I had not been [before] sad in his presence. 002:002 The king said to me, Why is your face sad, seeing you are not sick? this is nothing else but sorrow of heart. Then I was very sore afraid. 002:003 I said to the king, Let the king live forever: why should not my face be sad, when the city, the place of my fathers' tombs, lies waste, and the gates of it are consumed with fire? 002:004 Then the king said to me, For what

do you make request? So I prayed to the God of heaven. 002:005 I said to the king, If it please the king, and if your servant have found favor in your sight, that you would send me to Judah, to the city of my fathers' tombs, that I may build it. 002:006 The king said to me (the queen also sitting by him), For how long shall your journey be? and when will you return? So it pleased the king to send me; and I set him a time. 002:007 Moreover I said to the king, If it please the king, let letters be given me to the governors beyond the River, that they may let me pass through until I come to Judah; 002:008 and a

letter to Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, that he may give me timber to make beams for the gates of the castle which appertains to the house, and for the wall of the city, and for the house that I shall enter into. The king granted me, according to the good hand of my God on me. 002:009 Then I came to the governors beyond the River, and gave them the king's letters. Now the king had sent with me captains of the army and horsemen. 002:010 When Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, heard of it, it grieved them exceedingly, because a man had come to seek

the welfare of the children of Israel.

**002:011 So I came to Jerusalem,
and was there three days. 002:012 I
arose in the night, I and some few
men with me; neither told I any
man what my God put into my
heart to do for Jerusalem; neither
was there any animal with me,
except the animal that I rode on.**

**002:013 I went out by night by the
valley gate, even toward the
jackal's well, and to the dung gate,
and viewed the walls of Jerusalem,
which were broken down, and the
gates of it were consumed with fire.**

**002:014 Then I went on to the
spring gate and to the king's pool:
but there was no place for the**

animal that was under me to pass.

002:015 Then went I up in the night by the brook, and viewed the wall; and I turned back, and entered by the valley gate, and so returned.

002:016 The rulers didn't know where I went, or what I did; neither had I as yet told it to the Jews, nor to the priests, nor to the nobles, nor to the rulers, nor to the rest who did the work. 002:017 Then said I to them, You see the evil case that we are in, how Jerusalem lies waste, and the gates of it are burned with fire: come, and let us build up the wall of Jerusalem, that we be no more a reproach. 002:018 I told them of the hand of my God

which was good on me, as also of the king's words that he had spoken to me. They said, Let us rise up and build. So they strengthened their hands for the good [work].

002:019 But when Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, and Geshem the Arabian, heard it, they ridiculed us, and despised us, and said, What is this thing that you do? will you rebel against the king? 002:020

Then answered I them, and said to them, The God of heaven, he will prosper us; therefore we his servants will arise and build: but you have no portion, nor right, nor memorial, in Jerusalem. 003:001

Then Eliashib the high priest rose up with his brothers the priests, and they built the sheep gate; they sanctified it, and set up the doors of it; even to the tower of Hammeah they sanctified it, to the tower of Hananel. 003:002 Next to him built the men of Jericho. Next to them built Zaccur the son of Imri.

003:003 The fish gate did the sons of Hassenaah build; they laid the beams of it, and set up the doors of it, the bolts of it, and the bars of it.

003:004 Next to them repaired Meremoth the son of Uriah, the son of Hakkoz. Next to them repaired Meshullam the son of Berechiah, the son of Meshezabel. Next to

them repaired Zadok the son of Baana. 003:005 Next to them the Tekoites repaired; but their nobles didn't put their necks to the work of their lord. 003:006 The old gate repaired Joiada the son of Paseah and Meshullam the son of Besodeiah; they laid the beams of it, and set up the doors of it, and the bolts of it, and the bars of it. 003:007 Next to them repaired Melatiah the Gibeonite, and Jadon the Meronothite, the men of Gibeon, and of Mizpah, [that appertained] to the throne of the governor beyond the River. 003:008 Next to him repaired Uzziel the son of Harhaiah, goldsmiths. Next to

him repaired Hananiah one of the perfumers, and they fortified Jerusalem even to the broad wall.

003:009 Next to them repaired Rephaiah the son of Hur, the ruler of half the district of Jerusalem.

003:010 Next to them repaired Jedaiah the son of Harumaph, over against his house. Next to him repaired Hattush the son of Hashabneiah. 003:011 Malchijah the son of Harim, and Hasshub the son of Pahathmoab, repaired another portion, and the tower of the furnaces. 003:012 Next to him repaired Shallum the son of Hallohesh, the ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, he and his

daughters. 003:013 The valley gate repaired Hanun, and the inhabitants of Zanoah; they built it, and set up the doors of it, the bolts of it, and the bars of it, and one thousand cubits of the wall to the dung gate. 003:014 The dung gate repaired Malchijah the son of Rechab, the ruler of the district of Beth Haccherem; he built it, and set up the doors of it, the bolts of it, and the bars of it. 003:015 The spring gate repaired Shallun the son of Colhozeh, the ruler of the district of Mizpah; he built it, and covered it, and set up the doors of it, the bolts of it, and the bars of it, and the wall of the pool of Shelah

by the king's garden, even to the stairs that go down from the city of David. 003:016 After him repaired Nehemiah the son of Azbuk, the ruler of half the district of Beth Zur, to the place over against the tombs of David, and to the pool that was made, and to the house of the mighty men. 003:017 After him repaired the Levites, Rehum the son of Bani. Next to him repaired Hashabiah, the ruler of half the district of Keilah, for his district. 003:018 After him repaired their brothers, Bavvai the son of Henadad, the ruler of half the district of Keilah. 003:019 Next to him repaired Ezer the son of

**Jeshua, the ruler of Mizpah,
another portion, over against the
ascent to the armory at the turning
[of the wall]. 003:020 After him
Baruch the son of Zabbai earnestly
repaired another portion, from the
turning [of the wall] to the door of
the house of Eliashib the high
priest. 003:021 After him repaired
Meremoth the son of Uriah the son
of Hakkoz another portion, from
the door of the house of Eliashib
even to the end of the house of
Eliashib. 003:022 After him
repaired the priests, the men of the
Plain. 003:023 After them repaired
Benjamin and Hasshub over
against their house. After them**

**repaired Azariah the son of
Maaseiah the son of Ananiah beside
his own house. 003:024 After him
repaired Binnui the son of
Henadad another portion, from the
house of Azariah to the turning [of
the wall], and to the corner.**

**003:025 Palal the son of Uzai
[repaired] over against the turning
[of the wall], and the tower that
stands out from the upper house of
the king, which is by the court of
the guard. After him Pedaiah the
son of Parosh [repaired]. 003:026
(Now the Nethinim lived in Ophel,
to the place over against the water
gate toward the east, and the tower
that stands out.) 003:027 After him**

the Tekoites repaired another portion, over against the great tower that stands out, and to the wall of Ophel. 003:028 Above the horse gate repaired the priests, everyone over against his own house. 003:029 After them repaired Zadok the son of Immer over against his own house. After him repaired Shemaiah the son of Shecaniah, the keeper of the east gate. 003:030 After him repaired Hananiah the son of Shelemiah, and Hanun the sixth son of Zalaph, another portion. After him repaired Meshullam the son of Berechiah over against his chamber. 003:031 After him repaired Malchijah one

of the goldsmiths to the house of the Nethinim, and of the merchants, over against the gate of Hammiphkad, and to the ascent of the corner. 003:032 Between the ascent of the corner and the sheep gate repaired the goldsmiths and the merchants. 004:001 But it happened that when Sanballat heard that we were building the wall, he was angry, and took great indignation, and mocked the Jews. 004:002 He spoke before his brothers and the army of Samaria, and said, What are these feeble Jews doing? will they fortify themselves? will they sacrifice? will they make an end in a day? will

**they revive the stones out of the
heaps of rubbish, seeing they are
burned? 004:003 Now Tobiah the
Ammonite was by him, and he said,
Even that which they are building,
if a fox go up, he shall break down
their stone wall. 004:004 Hear, our
God; for we are despised: and turn
back their reproach on their own
head, and give them up for a spoil
in a land of captivity; 004:005 and
don't cover their iniquity, and don't
let their sin be blotted out from
before you; for they have provoked
[you] to anger before the builders.
004:006 So we built the wall; and
all the wall was joined together to
half [the height] of it: for the people**

had a mind to work. 004:007 But it happened that when Sanballat, Tobiah, the Arabians, the Ammonites, and the Ashdodites heard that the repairing of the walls of Jerusalem went forward, [and] that the breaches began to be stopped, then they were very angry; 004:008 and they conspired all of them together to come and fight against Jerusalem, and to cause confusion therein. 004:009 But we made our prayer to our God, and set a watch against them day and night, because of them. 004:010 Judah said, The strength of the bearers of burdens is decayed, and there is much rubbish; so that

we are not able to build the wall.

004:011 Our adversaries said, They shall not know, neither see, until we come into the midst of them, and kill them, and cause the work to cease. 004:012 It happened that when the Jews who lived by them came, they said to us ten times from all places, You must return to us.

004:013 Therefore set I in the lowest parts of the space behind the wall, in the open places, I set [there] the people after their families with their swords, their spears, and their bows. 004:014 I looked, and rose up, and said to the nobles, and to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, Don't be you

afraid of them: remember the Lord, who is great and awesome, and fight for your brothers, your sons, and your daughters, your wives, and your houses. 004:015 It happened, when our enemies heard that it was known to us, and God had brought their counsel to nothing, that we returned all of us to the wall, everyone to his work. 004:016 It happened from that time forth, that half of my servants worked in the work, and half of them held the spears, the shields, and the bows, and the coats of mail; and the rulers were behind all the house of Judah. 004:017 They all built the wall and those who

**bore burdens loaded themselves;
everyone with one of his hands
worked in the work, and with the
other held his weapon; 004:018 and
the builders, everyone had his
sword girded by his side, and so
built. He who sounded the trumpet
was by me. 004:019 I said to the
nobles, and to the rulers and to the
rest of the people, The work is
great and large, and we are
separated on the wall, one far from
another: 004:020 in whatever place
you hear the sound of the trumpet,
resort you there to us; our God will
fight for us. 004:021 So we worked
in the work: and half of them held
the spears from the rising of the**

morning until the stars appeared.
004:022 Likewise at the same time
said I to the people, Let everyone
with his servant lodge within
Jerusalem, that in the night they
may be a guard to us, and may
labor in the day. 004:023 So neither
I, nor my brothers, nor my
servants, nor the men of the guard
who followed me, none of us put off
our clothes, everyone [went with]
his weapon [to] the water. 005:001
Then there arose a great cry of the
people and of their wives against
their brothers the Jews. 005:002
For there were that said, We, our
sons and our daughters, are many:
let us get grain, that we may eat

and live. 005:003 Some also there were that said, We are mortgaging our fields, and our vineyards, and our houses: let us get grain, because of the dearth. 005:004 There were also that said, We have borrowed money for the king's tribute [on] our fields and our vineyards. 005:005 Yet now our flesh is as the flesh of our brothers, our children as their children: and behold, we bring into bondage our sons and our daughters to be servants, and some of our daughters are brought into bondage [already]: neither is it in our power to help it; for other men have our fields and our vineyards.

005:006 I was very angry when I heard their cry and these words.

005:007 Then I consulted with myself, and contended with the nobles and the rulers, and said to them, You exact usury, everyone of his brother. I held a great assembly against them. 005:008 I said to them, We after our ability have redeemed our brothers the Jews, that were sold to the nations; and would you even sell your brothers, and should they be sold to us? Then held they their peace, and found never a word. 005:009 Also I said, The thing that you do is not good: ought you not to walk in the fear of our God, because of the reproach of

the nations our enemies? 005:010 I likewise, my brothers and my servants, do lend them money and grain. Please let us leave off this usury. 005:011 Please restore to them, even this day, their fields, their vineyards, their olive groves, and their houses, also the hundredth part of the money, and of the grain, the new wine, and the oil, that you exact of them. 005:012 Then said they, We will restore them, and will require nothing of them; so will we do, even as you say. Then I called the priests, and took an oath of them, that they would do according to this promise. 005:013 Also I shook out my lap,

and said, So God shake out every man from his house, and from his labor, that doesn't perform this promise; even thus be he shaken out, and emptied. All the assembly said, Amen, and praised Yahweh. The people did according to this promise. 005:014 Moreover from the time that I was appointed to be their governor in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year even to the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes the king, [that is], twelve years, I and my brothers have not eaten the bread of the governor. 005:015 But the former governors who were before me were chargeable to the people, and

**took of them bread and wine,
besides forty shekels of silver; yes,
even their servants bore rule over
the people: but I didn't do so,
because of the fear of God. 005:016
Yes, also I continued in the work of
this wall, neither bought we any
land: and all my servants were
gathered there to the work. 005:017
Moreover there were at my table,
of the Jews and the rulers, one
hundred fifty men, besides those
who came to us from among the
nations that were round about us.
005:018 Now that which was
prepared for one day was one ox
and six choice sheep; also fowls
were prepared for me, and once in**

**ten days store of all sorts of wine:
yet for all this I didn't demand the
bread of the governor, because the
bondage was heavy on this people.
005:019 Remember to me, my God,
for good, all that I have done for
this people. 006:001 Now it
happened, when it was reported to
Sanballat and Tobiah, and to
Geshem the Arabian, and to the
rest of our enemies, that I had built
the wall, and that there was no
breach left therein; (though even to
that time I had not set up the doors
in the gates;) 006:002 that
Sanballat and Geshem sent to me,
saying, Come, let us meet together
in [one of] the villages in the plain**

of Ono. But they thought to do me mischief. 006:003 I sent messengers to them, saying, I am doing a great work, so that I can't come down: why should the work cease, while I leave it, and come down to you? 006:004 They sent to me four times after this sort; and I answered them after the same manner. 006:005 Then sent Sanballat his servant to me in like manner the fifth time with an open letter in his hand, 006:006 in which was written, It is reported among the nations, and Gashmu says it, that you and the Jews think to rebel; for which cause you are building the wall: and you would be their king,

**according to these words. 006:007
You have also appointed prophets
to preach of you at Jerusalem,
saying, There is a king in Judah:
and now shall it be reported to the
king according to these words.
Come now therefore, and let us
take counsel together. 006:008 Then
I sent to him, saying, There are no
such things done as you say, but
you feign them out of your own
heart. 006:009 For they all would
have made us afraid, saying, Their
hands shall be weakened from the
work, that it not be done. But now,
[God], strengthen you my hands.
006:010 I went to the house of
Shemaiah the son of Delaiah the**

**son of Mehetabel, who was shut up;
and he said, Let us meet together in
the house of God, within the
temple, and let us shut the doors of
the temple: for they will come to
kill you; yes, in the night will they
come to kill you. 006:011 I said,
Should such a man as I flee? and
who is there that, being such as I,
would go into the temple to save his
life? I will not go in. 006:012 I
discerned, and behold, God had not
sent him; but he pronounced this
prophecy against me: and Tobiah
and Sanballat had hired him.
006:013 For this cause was he
hired, that I should be afraid, and
do so, and sin, and that they might**

have matter for an evil report, that they might reproach me. 006:014 Remember, my God, Tobiah and Sanballat according to these their works, and also the prophetess Noadiah, and the rest of the prophets, that would have put me in fear. 006:015 So the wall was finished in the twenty-fifth [day] of [the month] Elul, in fifty-two days. 006:016 It happened, when all our enemies heard [of it], that all the nations that were about us feared, and were much cast down in their own eyes; for they perceived that this work was worked of our God. 006:017 Moreover in those days the nobles of Judah sent many letters

**to Tobiah, and [the letters] of
Tobiah came to them. 006:018 For
there were many in Judah sworn to
him, because he was the son-in-law
of Shecaniah the son of Arah; and
his son Jehohanan had taken the
daughter of Meshullam the son of
Berechiah as wife. 006:019 Also
they spoke of his good deeds before
me, and reported my words to him.
Tobiah sent letters to put me in
fear. 007:001 Now it happened,
when the wall was built, and I had
set up the doors, and the porters
and the singers and the Levites
were appointed, 007:002 that I gave
my brother Hanani, and Hananiah
the governor of the castle, charge**

over Jerusalem; for he was a faithful man, and feared God above many. 007:003 I said to them, Don't let the gates of Jerusalem be opened until the sun be hot; and while they stand [on guard], let them shut the doors, and bar you them: and appoint watches of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, everyone in his watch, and everyone [to be] over against his house. 007:004

Now the city was wide and large; but the people were few therein, and the houses were not built.

007:005 My God put into my heart to gather together the nobles, and the rulers, and the people, that they might be reckoned by genealogy. I

**found the book of the genealogy of
those who came up at the first, and
I found written therein: 007:006**

**These are the children of the
province, who went up out of the
captivity of those who had been
carried away, whom**

**Nebuchadnezzar the king of
Babylon had carried away, and
who returned to Jerusalem and to
Judah, everyone to his city;**

007:007 who came with

**Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah,
Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani,
Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth,
Bigvai, Nehum, Baanah. The**

**number of the men of the people of
Israel: 007:008 The children of**

Parosh, two thousand one hundred seventy-two. 007:009 The children of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy-two. 007:010 The children of Arah, six hundred fifty-two. 007:011 The children of Pahathmoab, of the children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand eight hundred [and] eighteen. 007:012 The children of Elam, one thousand two hundred fifty-four. 007:013 The children of Zattu, eight hundred forty-five. 007:014 The children of Zaccai, seven hundred sixty. 007:015 The children of Binnui, six hundred forty-eight. 007:016 The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty-eight.

007:017 The children of Azgad, two thousand three hundred twenty-two. 007:018 The children of Adonikam, six hundred sixty-seven. 007:019 The children of Bigvai, two thousand sixty-seven. 007:020 The children of Adin, six hundred fifty-five. 007:021 The children of Ater, of Hezekiah, ninety-eight. 007:022 The children of Hashum, three hundred Twenty-eight. 007:023 The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty-four. 007:024 The children of Hariph, one hundred twelve. 007:025 The children of Gibeon, ninety-five. 007:026 The men of Bethlehem and Netophah, one hundred eighty-eight. 007:027 The

**men of Anathoth, one hundred
twenty-eight. 007:028 The men of
Beth Azmaveth, forty-two. 007:029
The men of Kiriath Jearim,
Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven
hundred forty-three. 007:030 The
men of Ramah and Geba, six
hundred twenty-one. 007:031 The
men of Michmas, one hundred and
twenty-two. 007:032 The men of
Bethel and Ai, a hundred twenty-
three. 007:033 The men of the other
Nebo, fifty-two. 007:034 The
children of the other Elam, one
thousand two hundred fifty-four.
007:035 The children of Harim,
three hundred twenty. 007:036 The
children of Jericho, three hundred**

forty-five. 007:037 The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty-one. 007:038 The children of Senaah, three thousand nine hundred thirty. 007:039 The priests: The children of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua, nine hundred seventy-three. 007:040 The children of Immer, one thousand fifty-two. 007:041 The children of Pashhur, one thousand two hundred forty-seven. 007:042 The children of Harim, one thousand [and] seventeen. 007:043 The Levites: the children of Jeshua, of Kadmiel, of the children of Hodevah, seventy-four. 007:044 The singers: the children of Asaph, one hundred

**forty-eight. 007:045 The porters:
the children of Shallum, the
children of Ater, the children of
Talmon, the children of Akkub, the
children of Hatita, the children of
Shobai, one hundred thirty-eight.
007:046 The Nethinim: the children
of Ziha, the children of Hasupha,
the children of Tabbaoth, 007:047
the children of Keros, the children
of Sia, the children of Padon,
007:048 the children of Lebana, the
children of Hagaba, the children of
Salmai, 007:049 the children of
Hanan, the children of Giddel, the
children of Gahar, 007:050 the
children of Reaiah, the children of
Rezin, the children of Nekoda,**

**007:051 the children of Gazzam,
the children of Uzza, the children of
Paseah. 007:052 The children of
Besai, the children of Meunim, the
children of Nephushesim, 007:053
the children of Bakbuk, the
children of Hakupha, the children
of Harhur, 007:054 the children of
Bazlith, the children of Mehida, the
children of Harsha, 007:055 the
children of Barkos, the children of
Sisera, the children of Temah,
007:056 the children of Neziah, the
children of Hatipha. 007:057 The
children of Solomon's servants: the
children of Sotai, the children of
Sophereth, the children of Perida,
007:058 the children of Jaala, the**

**children of Darkon, the children of
Giddel, 007:059 the children of
Shephatiah, the children of Hattil,
the children of Pochereth
Hazzebaim, the children of Amon.
007:060 All the Nethinim, and the
children of Solomon's servants,
were three hundred ninety-two.
007:061 These were those who went
up from Tel Melah, Tel Harsha,
Cherub, Addon, and Immer; but
they could not show their fathers'
houses, nor their seed, whether they
were of Israel: 007:062 The
children of Delaiah, the children of
Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six
hundred forty-two. 007:063 Of the
priests: the children of Hobaiah,**

the children of Hakkoz, the children of Barzillai, who took a wife of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite, and was called after their name. 007:064 These sought their register [among] those who were reckoned by genealogy, but it was not found: therefore were they deemed polluted and put from the priesthood. 007:065 The governor said to them, that they should not eat of the most holy things, until there stood up a priest with Urim and Thummim. 007:066 The whole assembly together was forty-two thousand three hundred sixty, 007:067 besides their male servants and their female servants, of whom

there were seven thousand three hundred thirty-seven: and they had two hundred forty-five singing men and singing women. 007:068 Their horses were seven hundred thirty-six; their mules, two hundred forty-five; 007:069 [their] camels, four hundred thirty-five; [their] donkeys, six thousand seven hundred twenty. 007:070 Some from among the heads of fathers' [houses] gave to the work. The governor gave to the treasury one thousand darics of gold, fifty basins, and five hundred thirty priests' garments. 007:071 Some of the heads of fathers' [houses] gave into the treasury of the work

twenty thousand darics of gold, and two thousand two hundred minas of silver. 007:072 That which the rest of the people gave was twenty thousand darics of gold, and two thousand minas of silver, and sixty-seven priests' garments. 007:073 So the priests, and the Levites, and the porters, and the singers, and some of the people, and the Nethinim, and all Israel, lived in their cities. When the seventh month was come, the children of Israel were in their cities. 008:001 All the people gathered themselves together as one man into the broad place that was before the water gate; and they spoke to Ezra the scribe to bring

**the book of the law of Moses, which
Yahweh had commanded to Israel.**

**008:002 Ezra the priest brought the
law before the assembly, both men
and women, and all who could hear
with understanding, on the first
day of the seventh month. 008:003**

**He read therein before the broad
place that was before the water
gate from early morning until
midday, in the presence of the men
and the women, and of those who
could understand; and the ears of
all the people were [attentive] to the
book of the law. 008:004 Ezra the
scribe stood on a pulpit of wood,
which they had made for the
purpose; and beside him stood**

**Mattithiah, and Shema, and
Anaiiah, and Uriah, and Hilkiah,
and Maaseiah, on his right hand;
and on his left hand, Pedaiah, and
Mishael, and Malchijah, and
Hashum, and Hashbaddanah,
Zechariah, [and] Meshullam.**

**008:005 Ezra opened the book in
the sight of all the people; (for he
was above all the people;) and
when he opened it, all the people
stood up: 008:006 and Ezra blessed
Yahweh, the great God. All the
people answered, Amen, Amen,
with the lifting up of their hands:
and they bowed their heads, and
worshipped Yahweh with their faces
to the ground. 008:007 Also Jeshua,**

**and Bani, and Sherebiah, Jamin,
Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodiah,
Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah,
Jozabad, Hanan, Pelaiah, and the
Levites, caused the people to
understand the law: and the people
[stood] in their place. 008:008 They
read in the book, in the law of God,
distinctly; and they gave the sense,
so that they understood the
reading. 008:009 Nehemiah, who
was the governor, and Ezra the
priest the scribe, and the Levites
who taught the people, said to all
the people, This day is holy to
Yahweh your God; don't mourn,
nor weep. For all the people wept,
when they heard the words of the**

**law. 008:010 Then he said to them,
Go your way, eat the fat, and drink
the sweet, and send portions to him
for whom nothing is prepared; for
this day is holy to our Lord. Don't
be grieved; for the joy of Yahweh is
your strength. 008:011 So the
Levites stilled all the people, saying,
Hold your peace, for the day is
holy; neither be you grieved.
008:012 All the people went their
way to eat, and to drink, and to
send portions, and to make great
mirth, because they had
understood the words that were
declared to them. 008:013 On the
second day were gathered together
the heads of fathers' [houses] of all**

the people, the priests, and the Levites, to Ezra the scribe, even to give attention to the words of the law. 008:014 They found written in the law, how that Yahweh had commanded by Moses, that the children of Israel should dwell in booths in the feast of the seventh month; 008:015 and that they should publish and proclaim in all their cities, and in Jerusalem, saying, Go forth to the mountain, and get olive branches, and branches of wild olive, and myrtle branches, and palm branches, and branches of thick trees, to make booths, as it is written. 008:016 So the people went forth, and brought

them, and made themselves booths, everyone on the roof of his house, and in their courts, and in the courts of the house of God, and in the broad place of the water gate, and in the broad place of the gate of Ephraim. 008:017 All the assembly of those who were come again out of the captivity made booths, and lived in the booths; for since the days of Jeshua the son of Nun to that day the children of Israel had not done so. There was very great gladness. 008:018 Also day by day, from the first day to the last day, he read in the book of the law of God. They kept the feast seven days; and on the eighth day

was a solemn assembly, according to the ordinance. 009:001 Now in the twenty-fourth day of this month the children of Israel were assembled with fasting, and with sackcloth, and earth on them.

009:002 The seed of Israel separated themselves from all foreigners, and stood and confessed their sins, and the iniquities of their fathers. 009:003 They stood up in their place, and read in the book of the law of Yahweh their God a fourth part of the day; and [another] fourth part they confessed, and worshiped Yahweh their God. 009:004 Then stood up on the stairs of the Levites, Jeshua,

**and Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah,
Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, [and]
Chenani, and cried with a loud
voice to Yahweh their God. 009:005
Then the Levites, Jeshua, and
Kadmiel, Bani, Hashabneiah,
Sherebiah, Hodiah, Shebaniah,
[and] Pethahiah, said, Stand up
and bless Yahweh your God from
everlasting to everlasting; and
blessed be your glorious name,
which is exalted above all blessing
and praise. 009:006 You are
Yahweh, even you alone; you have
made heaven, the heaven of
heavens, with all their army, the
earth and all things that are
thereon, the seas and all that is in**

**them, and you preserve them all;
and the army of heaven worships
you. 009:007 You are Yahweh the
God, who did choose Abram, and
brought him forth out of Ur of the
Chaldees, and gave him the name
of Abraham, 009:008 and found his
heart faithful before you, and made
a covenant with him to give the
land of the Canaanite, the Hittite,
the Amorite, and the Perizzite, and
the Jebusite, and the Girgashite, to
give it to his seed, and have
performed your words; for you are
righteous. 009:009 You saw the
affliction of our fathers in Egypt,
and heard their cry by the Red
Sea{or, Sea of Reeds}, 009:010 and**

**shown signs and wonders on
Pharaoh, and on all his servants,
and on all the people of his land;
for you knew that they dealt
proudly against them, and did get
you a name, as it is this day.**

**009:011 You divided the sea before
them, so that they went through the
midst of the sea on the dry land;
and their pursuers you did cast into
the depths, as a stone into the
mighty waters. 009:012 Moreover
in a pillar of cloud you led them by
day; and in a pillar of fire by night,
to give them light in the way in
which they should go. 009:013 You
came down also on Mount Sinai,
and spoke with them from heaven,**

**and gave them right ordinances
and true laws, good statutes and
commandments, 009:014 and made
known to them your holy Sabbath,
and commanded them
commandments, and statutes, and
a law, by Moses your servant,
009:015 and gave them bread from
the sky for their hunger, and
brought forth water for them out of
the rock for their thirst, and
commanded those who they should
go in to possess the land which you
had sworn to give them. 009:016
But they and our fathers dealt
proudly and hardened their neck,
and didn't listen to your
commandments, 009:017 and**

**refused to obey, neither were
mindful of your wonders that you
did among them, but hardened
their neck, and in their rebellion
appointed a captain to return to
their bondage. But you are a God
ready to pardon, gracious and
merciful, slow to anger, and
abundant in loving kindness, and
didn't forsake them. 009:018 Yes,
when they had made them a molten
calf, and said, This is your God
who brought you up out of Egypt,
and had committed awful
blasphemies; 009:019 yet you in
your manifold mercies didn't
forsake them in the wilderness: the
pillar of cloud didn't depart from**

over them by day, to lead them in the way; neither the pillar of fire by night, to show them light, and the way in which they should go.

009:020 You gave also your good Spirit to instruct them, and didn't withhold your manna from their mouth, and gave them water for their thirst. 009:021 Yes, forty years did you sustain them in the wilderness, [and] they lacked nothing; their clothes didn't grow old, and their feet didn't swell.

009:022 Moreover you gave them kingdoms and peoples, which you did allot after their portions: so they possessed the land of Sihon, even the land of the king of

Heshbon, and the land of Og king of Bashan. 009:023 Their children also multiplied you as the stars of the sky, and brought them into the land concerning which you did say to their fathers, that they should go in to possess it. 009:024 So the children went in and possessed the land, and you subdued before them the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, and gave them into their hands, with their kings, and the peoples of the land, that they might do with them as they would. 009:025 They took fortified cities, and a fat land, and possessed houses full of all good things, cisterns hewn out, vineyards, and

olive groves, and fruit trees in abundance: so they ate, and were filled, and became fat, and delighted themselves in your great goodness. 009:026 Nevertheless they were disobedient, and rebelled against you, and cast your law behind their back, and killed your prophets that testified against them to turn them again to you, and they committed awful blasphemies.

009:027 Therefore you delivered them into the hand of their adversaries, who distressed them: and in the time of their trouble, when they cried to you, you heard from heaven; and according to your manifold mercies you gave

them saviors who saved them out of the hand of their adversaries.

009:028 But after they had rest, they did evil again before you; therefore left you them in the hand of their enemies, so that they had the dominion over them: yet when they returned, and cried to you, you heard from heaven; and many times did you deliver them according to your mercies, 009:029 and testified against them, that you might bring them again to your law. Yet they dealt proudly, and didn't listen to your commandments, but sinned against your ordinances, (which if a man do, he shall live in them), and

**withdrew the shoulder, and
hardened their neck, and would not
hear. 009:030 Yet many years did
you bear with them, and testified
against them by your Spirit
through your prophets: yet would
they not give ear: therefore gave
you them into the hand of the
peoples of the lands. 009:031
Nevertheless in your manifold
mercies you did not make a full end
of them, nor forsake them; for you
are a gracious and merciful God.
009:032 Now therefore, our God,
the great, the mighty, and the
awesome God, who keep covenant
and loving kindness, don't let all
the travail seem little before you,**

**that has come on us, on our kings,
on our princes, and on our priests,
and on our prophets, and on our
fathers, and on all your people,
since the time of the kings of
Assyria to this day. 009:033**

**However you are just in all that is
come on us; for you have dealt
truly, but we have done wickedly;
009:034 neither have our kings, our
princes, our priests, nor our
fathers, kept your law, nor listened
to your commandments and your
testimonies with which you did
testify against them. 009:035 For
they have not served you in their
kingdom, and in your great
goodness that you gave them, and**

in the large and fat land which you gave before them, neither turned they from their wicked works.

009:036 Behold, we are servants this day, and as for the land that you gave to our fathers to eat the fruit of it and the good of it, behold, we are servants in it. 009:037 It yields much increase to the kings whom you have set over us because of our sins: also they have power over our bodies, and over our livestock, at their pleasure, and we are in great distress. 009:038 Yet for all this we make a sure covenant, and write it; and our princes, our Levites, [and] our priests, seal to it. 010:001 Now

**those who sealed were: Nehemiah
the governor, the son of Hacaliah,
and Zedekiah, 010:002 Seraiah,
Azariah, Jeremiah, 010:003
Pashhur, Amariah, Malchijah,
010:004 Hattush, Shebaniah,
Malluch, 010:005 Harim,
Meremoth, Obadiah, 010:006
Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,
010:007 Meshullam, Abijah,
Mijamin, 010:008 Maaziah, Bilgai,
Shemaiah; these were the priests.
010:009 The Levites: namely,
Jeshua the son of Azaniah, Binnui
of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel;
010:010 and their brothers,
Shebaniah, Hodiah, Kelita, Pelaiah,
Hanan, 010:011 Mica, Rehob,**

**Hashabiah, 010:012 Zaccur,
Sherebiah, Shebaniah, 010:013
Hodiah, Bani, Beninu. 010:014 The
chiefs of the people: Parosh,
Pahathmoab, Elam, Zattu, Bani,
010:015 Bunni, Azgad, Bebai,
010:016 Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,
010:017 Ater, Hezekiah, Azzur,
010:018 Hodiah, Hashum, Bezai,
010:019 Hariph, Anathoth, Nobai,
010:020 Magpiash, Meshullam,
Hezir, 010:021 Meshezabel, Zadok,
Jaddua, 010:022 Pelatiah, Hanan,
Anaiah, 010:023 Hoshea,
Hananiah, Hasshub, 010:024
Hallohesh, Pilha, Shobek, 010:025
Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,
010:026 and Ahiah, Hanan, Anan,**

010:027 Malluch, Harim, Baanah.

010:028 The rest of the people, the priests, the Levites, the porters, the singers, the Nethinim, and all those who had separated themselves from the peoples of the lands to the law of God, their wives, their sons, and their daughters, everyone who had knowledge, and understanding;

010:029 They joined with their brothers, their nobles, and entered into a curse, and into an oath, to walk in God's law, which was given by Moses the servant of God, and to observe and do all the commandments of Yahweh our Lord, and his ordinances and his statutes; 010:030 and that we

would not give our daughters to the peoples of the land, nor take their daughters for our sons; 010:031 and if the peoples of the land bring wares or any grain on the Sabbath day to sell, that we would not buy of them on the Sabbath, or on a holy day; and that we would forego the seventh year, and the exaction of every debt. 010:032 Also we made ordinances for us, to charge ourselves yearly with the third part of a shekel for the service of the house of our God; 010:033 for the show bread, and for the continual meal offering, and for the continual burnt offering, for the Sabbaths, for the new moons, for the set

feasts, and for the holy things, and for the sin offerings to make atonement for Israel, and for all the work of the house of our God.

010:034 We cast lots, the priests, the Levites, and the people, for the wood offering, to bring it into the house of our God, according to our fathers' houses, at times appointed, year by year, to burn on the altar of Yahweh our God, as it is written in the law; 010:035 and to bring the first fruits of our ground, and the first fruits of all fruit of all manner of trees, year by year, to the house of Yahweh; 010:036 also the firstborn of our sons, and of our livestock, as it is written in the law,

and the firstborn of our herds and of our flocks, to bring to the house of our God, to the priests who minister in the house of our God; 010:037 and that we should bring the first fruits of our dough, and our wave offerings, and the fruit of all manner of trees, the new wine and the oil, to the priests, to the chambers of the house of our God; and the tithes of our ground to the Levites; for they, the Levites, take the tithes in all the cities of our tillage. 010:038 The priest the son of Aaron shall be with the Levites, when the Levites take tithes: and the Levites shall bring up the tithe of the tithes to the house of our

God, to the chambers, into the treasure house. 010:039 For the children of Israel and the children of Levi shall bring the wave offering of the grain, of the new wine, and of the oil, to the chambers, where are the vessels of the sanctuary, and the priests who minister, and the porters, and the singers: and we will not forsake the house of our God. 011:001 The princes of the people lived in Jerusalem: the rest of the people also cast lots, to bring one of ten to dwell in Jerusalem the holy city, and nine parts in the [other] cities. 011:002 The people blessed all the men who willingly offered

themselves to dwell in Jerusalem.

011:003 Now these are the chiefs of the province who lived in

Jerusalem: but in the cities of

Judah lived everyone in his

possession in their cities, [to wit],

Israel, the priests, and the Levites,

and the Nethinim, and the children

of Solomon's servants. 011:004 In

Jerusalem lived certain of the

children of Judah, and of the

children of Benjamin. Of the

children of Judah: Athaiah the son

of Uzziah, the son of Zechariah, the

son of Amariah, the son of

Shephatiah, the son of Mahalalel,

of the children of Perez; 011:005

and Maaseiah the son of Baruch,

**the son of Colhozeh, the son of
Hazaiah, the son of Adaiah, the son
of Joiarib, the son of Zechariah, the
son of the Shilonite. 011:006 All the
sons of Perez who lived in
Jerusalem were four hundred sixty-
eight valiant men. 011:007 These
are the sons of Benjamin: Sallu the
son of Meshullam, the son of Joed,
the son of Pedaiah, the son of
Kolaiah, the son of Maaseiah, the
son of Ithiel, the son of Jeshaiiah.
011:008 After him Gabbai, Sallai,
nine hundred twenty-eight. 011:009
Joel the son of Zichri was their
overseer; and Judah the son of
Hassenuah was second over the
city. 011:010 Of the priests: Jedaiah**

**the son of Joiarib, Jachin, 011:011
Seraiah the son of Hilkiah, the son
of Meshullam, the son of Zadok,
the son of Meraioth, the son of
Ahitub, the ruler of the house of
God, 011:012 and their brothers
who did the work of the house,
eight hundred twenty-two; and
Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son
of Pelaliah, the son of Amzi, the son
of Zechariah, the son of Pashhur,
the son of Malchijah, 011:013 and
his brothers, chiefs of fathers'
[houses], two hundred forty-two;
and Amashsai the son of Azarel, the
son of Ahzai, the son of
Meshillemoth, the son of Immer,
011:014 and their brothers, mighty**

men of valor, one hundred twenty-eight; and their overseer was Zabdiel, the son of Haggedolim.

011:015 Of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Bunni; 011:016 and Shabbethai and Jozabad, of the chiefs of the Levites, who had the oversight of the outward business of the house of God; 011:017 and Mattaniah the son of Mica, the son of Zabdi, the son of Asaph, who was the chief to begin the thanksgiving in prayer, and Bakbukiah, the second among his brothers; and Abda the son of Shammua, the son of Galal, the son

of Jeduthun. 011:018 All the Levites in the holy city were two hundred eighty-four. 011:019 Moreover the porters, Akkub, Talmon, and their brothers, who kept watch at the gates, were one hundred seventy-two. 011:020 The residue of Israel, of the priests, the Levites, were in all the cities of Judah, everyone in his inheritance. 011:021 But the Nethinim lived in Ophel: and Ziha and Gishpa were over the Nethinim. 011:022 The overseer also of the Levites at Jerusalem was Uzzi the son of Bani, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Mica, of the sons of Asaph, the singers, over the

business of the house of God.

011:023 For there was a commandment from the king concerning them, and a settled provision for the singers, as every day required. 011:024 Pethahiah the son of Meshezabel, of the children of Zerah the son of Judah, was at the king's hand in all matters concerning the people.

011:025 As for the villages, with their fields, some of the children of Judah lived in Kiriath Arba and the towns of it, and in Dibon and the towns of it, and in Jekabzeel and the villages of it, 011:026 and in Jeshua, and in Moladah, and Beth Pelet, 011:027 and in Hazar

Shual, and in Beersheba and the towns of it, 011:028 and in Ziklag, and in Meconah and in the towns of it, 011:029 and in En Rimmon, and in Zorah, and in Jarmuth, 011:030 Zanoah, Adullam, and their villages, Lachish and the fields of it, Azekah and the towns of it. So they encamped from Beersheba to the valley of Hinnom. 011:031 The children of Benjamin also [lived] from Geba [onward], at Michmash and Aija, and at Bethel and the towns of it, 011:032 at Anathoth, Nob, Ananiah, 011:033 Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim, 011:034 Hadid, Zeboim, Neballat, 011:035 Lod, and Ono, the valley of craftsmen.

011:036 Of the Levites, certain divisions in Judah [were joined] to Benjamin. 012:001 Now these are the priests and the Levites who went up with Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra, 012:002 Amariah, Malluch, Hattush, 012:003 Shecaniah, Rehum, Meremoth, 012:004 Iddo, Ginnethoi, Abijah, 012:005 Mijamin, Maadiah, Bilgah, 012:006 Shemaiah, and Joiarib, Jedaiah. 012:007 Sallu, Amok, Hilkiah, Jedaiah. These were the chiefs of the priests and of their brothers in the days of Jeshua. 012:008 Moreover the Levites: Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel,

Sherebiah, Judah, [and] Mattaniah, who was over the thanksgiving, he and his brothers. 012:009 Also Bakbukiah and Unno, their brothers, were over against them according to their offices. 012:010 Jeshua became the father of Joiakim, and Joiakim became the father of Eliashib, and Eliashib became the father of Joiada, 012:011 and Joiada became the father of Jonathan, and Jonathan became the father of Jaddua. 012:012 In the days of Joiakim were priests, heads of fathers' [houses]: of Seraiah, Meraiah; of Jeremiah, Hananiah; 012:013 of Ezra, Meshullam; of Amariah,

**Jehohanan; 012:014 of Malluchi,
Jonathan; of Shebaniah, Joseph;
012:015 of Harim, Adna; of
Meraioth, Helkai; 012:016 of Iddo,
Zechariah; of Ginnethon,
Meshullam; 012:017 of Abijah,
Zichri; of Miniamin, of Moadiah,
Piltai; 012:018 of Bilgah,
Shammua; of Shemaiah,
Jehonathan; 012:019 and of
Jojarib, Mattenai; of Jedaiah, Uzzi;
012:020 of Sallai, Kallai; of Amok,
Eber; 012:021 of Hilkiah,
Hashabiah; of Jedaiah, Nethanel.
012:022 As for the Levites, in the
days of Eliashib, Joiada, and
Johanan, and Jaddua, there were
recorded the heads of fathers'**

[houses]; also the priests, in the reign of Darius the Persian.

012:023 The sons of Levi, heads of fathers' [houses], were written in the book of the chronicles, even until the days of Johanan the son of Eliashib. 012:024 The chiefs of the Levites: Hashabiah, Sherebiah, and Jeshua the son of Kadmiel, with their brothers over against them, to praise and give thanks, according to the commandment of David the man of God, watch next to watch.

012:025 Mattaniah, and Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, Akkub, were porters keeping the watch at the storehouses of the gates. 012:026

**These were in the days of Joiakim
the son of Jeshua, the son of
Jozadak, and in the days of
Nehemiah the governor, and of
Ezra the priest the scribe. 012:027**

**At the dedication of the wall of
Jerusalem they sought the Levites
out of all their places, to bring them
to Jerusalem, to keep the
dedication with gladness, both with
giving thanks, and with singing,
with cymbals, stringed instruments,
and with harps. 012:028 The sons
of the singers gathered themselves
together, both out of the plain
round about Jerusalem, and from
the villages of the Netophathites;
012:029 also from Beth Gilgal, and**

**out of the fields of Geba and
Azmaveth: for the singers had built
them villages round about
Jerusalem. 012:030 The priests and
the Levites purified themselves;
and they purified the people, and
the gates, and the wall. 012:031
Then I brought up the princes of
Judah on the wall, and appointed
two great companies who gave
thanks and went in procession.
[One went] on the right hand on
the wall toward the dung gate;
012:032 and after them went
Hoshaiah, and half of the princes of
Judah, 012:033 and Azariah, Ezra,
and Meshullam, 012:034 Judah,
and Benjamin, and Shemaiah, and**

Jeremiah, 012:035 and certain of the priests' sons with trumpets: Zechariah the son of Jonathan, the son of Shemaiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Micaiah, the son of Zaccur, the son of Asaph; 012:036 and his brothers, Shemaiah, and Azarel, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethanel, and Judah, Hanani, with the musical instruments of David the man of God; and Ezra the scribe was before them. 012:037 By the spring gate, and straight before them, they went up by the stairs of the city of David, at the ascent of the wall, above the house of David, even to the water gate eastward. 012:038

The other company of those who gave thanks went to meet them, and I after them, with the half of the people, on the wall, above the tower of the furnaces, even to the broad wall, 012:039 and above the gate of Ephraim, and by the old gate, and by the fish gate, and the tower of Hananel, and the tower of Hammeah, even to the sheep gate: and they stood still in the gate of the guard. 012:040 So stood the two companies of those who gave thanks in the house of God, and I, and the half of the rulers with me; 012:041 and the priests, Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Micaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah,

**with trumpets; 012:042 and
Maaseiah, and Shemaiah, and
Eleazar, and Uzzi, and Jehohanan,
and Malchijah, and Elam, and
Ezer. The singers sang loud, with
Jezrahiah their overseer. 012:043
They offered great sacrifices that
day, and rejoiced; for God had
made them rejoice with great joy;
and the women also and the
children rejoiced: so that the joy of
Jerusalem was heard even afar off.
012:044 On that day were men
appointed over the chambers for
the treasures, for the wave
offerings, for the first fruits, and
for the tithes, to gather into them,
according to the fields of the cities,**

**the portions appointed by the law
for the priests and Levites: for
Judah rejoiced for the priests and
for the Levites who waited. 012:045
They kept the charge of their God,
and the charge of the purification,
and [so did] the singers and the
porters, according to the
commandment of David, and of
Solomon his son. 012:046 For in the
days of David and Asaph of old
there was a chief of the singers, and
songs of praise and thanksgiving to
God. 012:047 All Israel in the days
of Zerubbabel, and in the days of
Nehemiah, gave the portions of the
singers and the porters, as every
day required: and they set apart**

**[that which was] for the Levites;
and the Levites set apart [that
which was] for the sons of Aaron.**

**013:001 On that day they read in
the book of Moses in the audience
of the people; and therein was
found written, that an Ammonite
and a Moabite should not enter into
the assembly of God forever,**

**013:002 because they didn't meet
the children of Israel with bread
and with water, but hired Balaam
against them, to curse them:**

**however our God turned the curse
into a blessing. 013:003 It came to
pass, when they had heard the law,
that they separated from Israel all
the mixed multitude. 013:004 Now**

before this, Eliashib the priest, who was appointed over the chambers of the house of our God, being allied to Tobiah, 013:005 had prepared for him a great chamber, where before they laid the meal offerings, the frankincense, and the vessels, and the tithes of the grain, the new wine, and the oil, which were given by commandment to the Levites, and the singers, and the porters; and the wave offerings for the priests. 013:006 But in all this [time] I was not at Jerusalem; for in the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon I went to the king: and after certain days asked I leave of the king, 013:007

and I came to Jerusalem, and understood the evil that Eliashib had done for Tobiah, in preparing him a chamber in the courts of the house of God. 013:008 It grieved me sore: therefore I cast forth all the household stuff of Tobiah out of the chamber. 013:009 Then I commanded, and they cleansed the chambers: and there brought I again the vessels of the house of God, with the meal offerings and the frankincense. 013:010 I perceived that the portions of the Levites had not been given them; so that the Levites and the singers, who did the work, were fled everyone to his field. 013:011 Then

**contended I with the rulers, and
said, Why is the house of God
forsaken? I gathered them together,
and set them in their place. 013:012
Then brought all Judah the tithe of
the grain and the new wine and the
oil to the treasuries. 013:013 I made
treasurers over the treasuries,
Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok
the scribe, and of the Levites,
Pedaiah: and next to them was
Hanan the son of Zaccur, the son of
Mattaniah; for they were counted
faithful, and their business was to
distribute to their brothers. 013:014
Remember me, my God,
concerning this, and don't wipe out
my good deeds that I have done for**

the house of my God, and for the observances of it. 013:015 In those days saw I in Judah some men treading winepresses on the Sabbath, and bringing in sheaves, and lading donkeys [therewith]; as also wine, grapes, and figs, and all manner of burdens, which they brought into Jerusalem on the Sabbath day: and I testified [against them] in the day in which they sold food. 013:016 There lived men of Tyre also therein, who brought in fish, and all manner of wares, and sold on the Sabbath to the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem. 013:017 Then I contended with the nobles of

Judah, and said to them, What evil thing is this that you do, and profane the Sabbath day? 013:018 Didn't your fathers do thus, and did not our God bring all this evil on us, and on this city? yet you bring more wrath on Israel by profaning the Sabbath. 013:019 It came to pass that, when the gates of Jerusalem began to be dark before the Sabbath, I commanded that the doors should be shut, and commanded that they should not be opened until after the Sabbath: and some of my servants set I over the gates, that there should no burden be brought in on the Sabbath day. 013:020 So the merchants and

sellers of all kind of wares lodged outside of Jerusalem once or twice. 013:021 Then I testified against them, and said to them, Why lodge you about the wall? if you do so again, I will lay hands on you. From that time forth came they no more on the Sabbath. 013:022 I commanded the Levites that they should purify themselves, and that they should come and keep the gates, to sanctify the Sabbath day. Remember to me, my God, this also, and spare me according to the greatness of your loving kindness. 013:023 In those days also saw I the Jews who had married women of Ashdod, of Ammon, [and] of Moab:

013:024 and their children spoke half in the speech of Ashdod, and could not speak in the Jews' language, but according to the language of each people. 013:025 I contended with them, and cursed them, and struck certain of them, and plucked off their hair, and made them swear by God, [saying], You shall not give your daughters to their sons, nor take their daughters for your sons, or for yourselves. 013:026 Did not Solomon king of Israel sin by these things? yet among many nations was there no king like him, and he was beloved of his God, and God made him king over all Israel:

nevertheless even him did foreign women cause to sin. 013:027 Shall we then listen to you to do all this great evil, to trespass against our God in marrying foreign women? 013:028 One of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was son-in-law to Sanballat the Horonite: therefore I chased him from me. 013:029 Remember them, my God, because they have defiled the priesthood, and the covenant of the priesthood, and of the Levites. 013:030 Thus cleansed I them from all foreigners, and appointed charges for the priests and for the Levites, everyone in his work; 013:031 and for the wood offering,

**at times appointed, and for the first
fruits. Remember me, my God, for
good.**

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